

Chapter 104 - Going Home

When Yan Lin and her mother came out of Jintai Temple, it wasn't very late yet, so as soon as they got in the car, Yan Lin said to the driver, "Back to the hospital."

Jiang Shu Yu was somewhat surprised and asked, "Ah Lin, it's already this time. Why don't we just go home? Just call Aunt Jiang."

"Aunt Jiang has never stayed overnight at the hospital. I'm not comfortable with that."

Jiang Shu Yu: "..."

That's someone else's biological mother - what's there to be uncomfortable about?! Jiang Shu Yu thought to herself.

However, since Yan Lin had said this, she didn't say anything more.

Yan Lin also fell silent, turning to look out the car window. Outside were streetlamps one after another, lighting the way home for all those who hadn't yet returned.

When mother and daughter arrived at the hospital room door, they happened to see Jiang Yu getting hot water to wipe Feng Yue's face and hands.

"Oh my, why did you come over so late?" Jiang Yu was quite surprised to see Yan Lin.

"Auntie, leave this to me." Yan Lin quickly rolled up her sleeves and took the basin from Jiang Yu's hands.

"Ah! Ah Lin, you..." Jiang Yu looked at Jiang Shu Yu and asked, "What's wrong?"

Yan Lin hadn't told Jiang Yu about the Jintai Temple matter, as it sounded too fantastical. So Jiang Shu Yu couldn't say that Yan Lin was sulking because she hadn't gotten answers at Jintai Temple.

She could only shake her head at Jiang Yu, "Let her do it. Let's sit over there for a bit."

Jiang Shu Yu pulled her to sit on the sofa and rest, taking the opportunity to chat about the lecture situation.

Meanwhile, Yan Lin carefully and gently wiped Feng Yue's face beside the hospital bed.

In the end, Yan Lin still stayed to keep vigil, while Jiang Yu was sent home by Jiang Shu Yu.

The hospital room returned to quiet. Yan Lin turned off the room lights and sat on the nearby sofa, reaching out to turn on the small night light on the coffee table.

The hospital room that had fallen into darkness suddenly brightened again. The warm yellow light fell into Yan Lin's eyes, gradually bringing her a hint of drowsiness.

This small night light was the gift Feng Yue had given her - the one they had bought at that little shop in Bali.

The gift had been brought over by Jiang Yu when she went to Feng Yue's bedroom to pack daily necessities, along with a letter in a light blue envelope.

Thinking of this, Yan Lin got up again and took her backpack from the end of the sofa, fishing out the envelope from inside a book.

The envelope had a number written on it - "Thirteen."

This was a secret between them. No one except her knew what this thirteen represented.

Yan Lin opened the envelope and once again took out the letter inside.

Feng Yue's handwriting was like her person - elegant and neat script, rarely using cursive, looking both clear and pleasing to the eye.

Ah Lin:

You should have seen the previous twelve letters, so I wrote thirteen for this one.

The gift in the package goes with this letter. I hope that night light can cure your insomnia during the days when I'm not here.

I asked you before what our relationship was. Actually, I'm not clear on this question myself. But let me summarize our emotional journey - it can probably only be described with four words: "fated but not destined."

I don't hope for you to follow me in death, so I wrote this letter, probably wanting to persuade you.

My departure is passive and irreversible. If I could choose, I would also choose to continue living. So I hope you won't actively give up the chance to live. Only by living is there everything, only by living is there hope.

When you showed such thoughts and intentions before, I never tried to dissuade you, because at that time I was wickedly thinking that I wanted you to die with me, so I tacitly allowed your thoughts.

But now it's different. Just like what we saw in the planetarium, every star is independent. Whether it explodes or reforms, that's the star's own business.

You should go be your own star, shine for yourself, and resist all storms for yourself.

Ah Lin, live on, like a star.

Take care.

Yan Lin read the letter carefully once more. Only when she saw the signature "Feng Yue's Final Letter" did she carefully fold the letter again and put it back in the envelope.

She was almost unable to hold on anymore. Clinging to intangible, ungraspable hope, every breath was a form of silent torment for her.

Yan Lin lay on her side on the sofa, and by the dim yellow light of the night lamp, she looked toward that sleeping face on the hospital bed. Teardrops flowed from the corners of her eyes one by one, overflowing past her nose and wetting a spot on the sofa.

Early the next morning, Yan Lin tidied herself up before the rounds doctor arrived, then wiped Feng Yue's face and hands again, and even helped comb Feng Yue's hair.

After the doctor came for routine checks, it was the nurse's turn to give Feng Yue her IV. Only after everything was finished did the hospital room become quiet again.

Yan Lin took a book from her bag and, as usual, sat in the chair beside the hospital bed and began reading quietly.

When Feng Yue opened her eyes, the first thing she saw was the bright white fluorescent light on the ceiling, which made her eyes feel dry, so she closed them again. After closing her eyes, she struggled to move her fingers, but only felt a sluggish sensation, like a rusty machine starting to move again.

Yan Lin's peripheral vision seemed to sense something moving, and she quickly turned to look, but only saw Feng Yue lying as motionless as usual.

Yan Lin disappointedly withdrew her gaze.

Feng Yue felt that even moving her fingers was very tiring, so she stopped and rested again. However, this time after resting, she could clearly hear the sounds around her and could feel that someone seemed to be sitting beside her.

Now when Feng Yue woke up, her body transmitted various kinds of discomfort, even her throat was so dry it itched. So she no longer thought about moving her body - she just wanted to drink something to moisten her throat.

She wanted to attract the attention of the person beside her, so she struggled to cough once. She felt this sound should be loud enough to attract others' attention.

But this sound was completely covered by the noise of the nearby medical equipment.

However, Yan Lin didn't miss this slight movement.

She quickly threw down the book in her hands and bent down close to Feng Yue. "Ah Yue! You're awake, aren't you!"

Yan Lin had been alone here for too long, so long that every organ in her body had become completely familiar with everything in this hospital room, whether sounds or placement of objects.

And this coughing sound under the medical equipment was a sound that had never occurred before.

This could only mean one thing - Feng Yue had awakened.

Feng Yue heard Yan Lin's voice and suddenly felt relieved, so the oxygen mask she was wearing immediately fogged up with a thick layer of white mist.

Seeing this, Yan Lin was even more certain that Feng Yue was awake. Even if she wasn't awake, she could at least hear her voice.

Yan Lin immediately pressed the call button by the bedside, then continued saying, "Ah Yue, you're awake, aren't you! Can you open your eyes? If you can't, just move your eyeballs."

Hearing this, Feng Yue felt a surge of defiance in her heart. Who was she looking down on? How could she not open her eyes?

So under Yan Lin's gaze, Feng Yue opened her eyes just a crack.

At the same time, doctors and nurses rushed over.

"Doctor! She just opened her eyes! I saw her open her eyes!" Yan Lin immediately gave way to the doctor.

After the doctors and nurses finished their examination, Yan Lin saw the doctor say to her with a face full of smiles, "Congratulations, Miss Yan! The patient's consciousness has completely awakened. You can give her a little water now. After she rests a bit more, I'll have someone take her for a complete examination. You can also contact Professor Fang and Dr. Wei to come take a look."

"Okay! Thank you, doctor, thank you, doctor!" Yan Lin saw them off, and even after they left, she could still hear the little nurses saying words like "miracle."

Yan Lin carefully followed the doctor's orders and fed Feng Yue a little water, then called to contact everyone.

With liquid moistening her throat, Feng Yue's throat wasn't so dry and itchy anymore. However, physical fatigue was unavoidable, so she fell asleep again.

When Feng Yue woke up again full of energy, she heard noisy sounds in the hospital room.

However, the noise was somewhat distant - it should be in the reception room.

Feng Yue felt that her hand without the IV was being held tightly by someone. She moved uncomfortably, then heard her mother's voice by her ear, "Sweetie? Sweetie, are you awake?"

Hearing her mother's voice with an obvious crying tone, Feng Yue opened her eyes slowly. As soon as she opened them, she saw Jiang Yu's disheveled hair and reddened eye rims.

"Mom..." Feng Yue opened her mouth, her weak and hoarse voice coming through the oxygen mask to everyone's ears.

Someone shouted toward the outside, "She's awake, she's awake! Come in quickly!"

Then there was a rush of hurried footsteps.

The second person to appear by Feng Yue's bedside was Feng He Hai. The CEO who commanded respect in the business world had to surrender completely before his suffering daughter, his eyes reddening.

"Sweetie, it's good that you're awake, it's good that you're awake!"

Then Feng Yue saw many familiar faces - her three aunts, her aunts' children, Professor Fang, Dr. Wei, and even Yan Lin's parents had come.

But there was notably one person missing - Yan Lin.

Feng Yue really wanted to ask why Yan Lin wasn't there, but she couldn't speak for long periods yet, so she could only scan all the people present with her eyes, round after round.

However, being her biological mother, Jiang Yu saw her looking around and around, and smiled knowingly, "Looking for Ah Lin? Don't worry, she just got too tense recently and collapsed after relaxing. She's resting in the next room. She'll come over when she wakes up."

Feng Yue felt relieved, then was taken by Professor Fang and Wei Yu Ran to do another complete comprehensive examination.

When she finished all this and was wheeled back to the hospital room, the first thing she saw was Yan Lin, still wearing a hospital gown, pacing anxiously back and forth in the room.

Yan Lin had come looking for Feng Yue as soon as she woke up, but was told that Feng Yue had gone for tests. She wanted to go find her but was afraid of missing Feng Yue, so she could only wait anxiously in the hospital room.

Feng Yue had been wheeled away lying on the hospital bed, so now as the nurses had just settled Feng Yue back in the room, Yan Lin completely ignored everyone else and rushed over to embrace her.

"Ah Yue, Ah Yue, Ah Yue..." She kept anxiously repeating Feng Yue's name.

Feng Yue reached out to pat her back, once and again - she was silently comforting her.

Then, hoarse and soft whispers sounded by Yan Lin's ear.

"I'm back..."